CHARACTER BOOKLET · No. 10

Avery *Quill*

BARN OWNER & THIS YEAR'S HOST

"Every board in this barn has a story, and you know every one of them."



FOR YOUR EYES ONLY

CORE CHARACTER · IN EVERY GAME

WHAT TO WEAR

Dress style: a cozy sweater dress, a flannel shirt tied at the waist and a big ring of old barn keys.

Suit style: corduroy trousers, a flannel shirt, a quilted vest and the same ring of keys.

YOUR DISH TO BRING

Roasted pumpkin soup

Store-bought is fine. Bring it in a dish you love and set it by your table tent.

How this booklet works

Before guests arrive: read page 2 alone. It holds your story and your secret.

Appetizers · Round 1: when the host starts Round 1, open page 3.

The Main Course · Round 2: the lower half of page 3.

Pie · Round 3: page 4. Then everyone votes over coffee.

Accusation over coffee: fill in your ballot. Then the truth is read aloud.

Printing? Single-sided, please, or cut page 3 on its dashed line, so later rounds can't show through.

THE GATHERING

The tenth annual Friendsgiving at Juniper Barn. Before the meal, cooking-show star Marigold "Goldie" Ashby tasted the first spoonful of gravy from her antique silver gravy boat, said she felt tired, settled into the rocking chair and never woke up. Every guest brought a dish. Every guest had a reason.

Never show this booklet to anyone. Bend the truth about your secret, never the evidence.

Your Secret Page

You are innocent.

You did not harm Goldie. You may still have something to hide.

Your story and your secret

You are about to open **Juniper Barn Kitchen**, a little café in the barn serving recipes from the cookbook the circle wrote together. The menus are already printed. Goldie's plan to sell the book, recipes and name included, would have put your café at risk. At 4:45 you and Goldie argued about it on the porch, and Jules walked up in the middle of it. You were angry. You never hurt anyone.

Where you were (your alibi)

- 4:00–4:30: greeting guests at the front door.
- 4:45: the porch argument with Goldie. Jules walked up the steps.
- 5:00–5:25: setting the long table in the main hall with Sage.
- 5:25–6:00: in the kitchen with Sage, warming your soup. Goldie filled her gravy boat at 5:30 and carried it into the pantry; at 5:58 she carried it back out.
- 5:50: right after Sage's oven timer rang, the pantry's back latch clacked twice, about a minute apart.

Your goal

Find out who did this in your barn. Keep the café a secret until Round 3, and win Best Detective.

If someone asks you…

"What were you and Goldie arguing about?" → "The barn's name. Goldie wanted it on the book. Friends argue." (The café can wait until Round 3.)

"Could anyone reach the pantry without passing you?" → "Only through the mudroom back door, and its latch clacks every time."

"Where were you at ten to six?" → "In the kitchen with Sage. We can vouch for each other."

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

PLAYING TIP

Stay in character and read your Share lines aloud when a round opens. Write down every time you hear on your Detective Notes: someone's story will not match the clock. You may dodge questions about your secret until your booklet says to share it, but never lie about the evidence.

Appetizers • *Round 1*

ROUND 1 · WAIT FOR THE HOST

Read only when the host starts Round 1.

Share

- You and Goldie argued on the porch at 4:45 about the barn's name. Goldie said, "The name goes on the book, Avery." Jules walked up the steps in the middle of it.
- Explain your barn (Evidence #2): the pantry sits between the kitchen and the mudroom, and its back door to the mudroom has a latch that clacks loudly every time it opens.

KEEP QUIET FOR NOW · Your café plans.

Ask

- **Sage:** "You saw Goldie fill the gravy boat. How did she seem?"
- **Jules:** "You walked up during my chat with Goldie. What did you hear?"

Your mission

Play the host: compliment two dishes on the buffet and ask who taught each cook to make it.

NOTES

✂ CUT OR FOLD HERE · ROUND 2 BELOW · WAIT FOR THE HOST

The Main Course • *Round 2*

ROUND 2 · WAIT FOR THE HOST

Read only when the host starts Round 2.

Share

- From 5:25 to 6:00 you were in the kitchen with Sage. The only person who used the kitchen door to the pantry was Goldie: in with the full boat at 5:30, out with it at 5:58.
- Right after Sage's oven timer rang at 5:50, you heard the pantry's back latch clack twice, about a minute apart. You heard it at no other time between 5:30 and 6:00.

Ask

- **Quinn:** "Your boots were muddy before dinner. Where did you go?"
- **Casey:** "Did your camera catch anything between 5:30 and 6:00?"

Your mission

Call for a quick toast to the cooks (cider or water) and ask Morgan to say a few words about the cookbook.

NOTES

Pie • *Round 3*

Read only when the host starts Round 3.

Share

- Your secret: you are opening Juniper Barn Kitchen, a café serving the cookbook's recipes, and Goldie's sale put it at risk. But you never left the kitchen, and Sage can say so.
- A reminder for everyone: the ladder in the mudroom is the only way up to the hayloft.

Ask

- **Morgan:** "Who has a copy of the cookbook proofs tonight?"
- **Jules:** "What happens to the gravy boat now?"

Your mission

Serve the pie (or ask Sage to) and get every player to name their top suspect in one word.

Who's who (public info · optional characters may not be playing)

10 Avery Quill
Barn owner & this year's host · *Roasted pumpkin soup*

11 Sage Montrose
Three-time pie contest champion · *Maple pecan pie*

12 Quinn Delacroix
Owner of Delacroix Cider Mill · *Hot spiced apple cider*

13 Morgan Feld
Cookbook editor · *Cranberry sauce*

14 Casey Thornbury
Producer of Supper with Goldie · *Mushroom stuffing*

15 Jules Carraway
Goldie's cousin · *Cheesy scalloped potatoes*

16 Harper Lindqvist (OPT.)
Farmers' market grower · *Roasted root vegetables*

17 Skyler Bontempo (OPT.)
Food truck owner · *Cornbread*

18 Arden Fairweather (OPT.)
The neighbor next door · *Green bean casserole*

19 Indigo Pike (OPT.)
Turkey farmer · *Roast turkey*

20 Charlie Okonjo (OPT.)
Cheese shop owner · *Autumn cheese board*

21 Wren Abernathy (OPT.)
Goldie's old roommate · *Homemade dinner rolls*

NOTES